left the country at Kathmandu's request. But the country still enjoys certain special relations with India, including reciprocal working rights and an open border, which facilitates economic and social interactions between the two countries. Millions of Nepal's citizens find work in India. Nepalese soldiers still serve in the Indian armed services, specifically the Gorkha regiments. The Indian government still pays pensions to tens of thousands of Nepali citizens as veterans of the Indian Army. [2]

Bangladesh, a large country of over 170 million people, has an unusual relationship with India for several reasons. India was involved in the creation of the country in 1971 and 1972, and many of Bangladesh's laws and political practices were modelled on India. While India worked to help Bangladesh set up the structures of an independent state in the 1970s, the assassination of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman and a series of military dictatorships saw a cooling of relations after 1977. At its core, Bangladesh saw a political conflict between two ideologies and identities, which had origins in the violence surrounding the 1971 Bangladesh War. One was a vision of the Awami League that played up Bengali identity and contested the more radical strains of Islamism. For example, under Sheikh Hasina, Mujib's daughter, Awami governments sought justice against those deemed guilty of war crimes in 1971. An alternative ideology found expression in the Bangladesh National Party (BNP), which was eventually led by Khaleda Zia, the widow of former President Ziaur Rahman, as well as other religiously-inspired movements. [3] India looms large in this political and ideological competition in Bangladesh, and New Delhi has sometimes found willing partners in Bangladesh's leadership in pursuing a shared agenda. After resolving the maritime boundary dispute in 2014 and the land boundary dispute in 2015, bilateral relations have transformed considerably, and Bangladesh has since become the largest overseas recipient of Indian state-backed investments and a significant trade partner. [4]

Sri Lanka and the Maldives have never had quite the same kind of relations with India as Nepal, Bhutan, and Bangladesh. Both were administered separately during the later years of British rule in India, and never had a protectorate relationship similar to Nepal and Bhutan. Their